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ANSWERS : STIMULUS BASED MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. All of the following factors led to the end of the Cold War except

(A) Increased U.S. military spending	**Incorrect**: The U.S. significantly increased its military spending under Reagan
(B) Reagan's diplomatic initiatives	**Incorrect**: Reagan's maintained constant pressure on the Soviet Union and had a civil relationship with Soviet General Secretary Mikhail Gorbachev.
(C) economic problems in Western Europe	**Correct**: Eastern, not Western, European economies were faltering under communism
(D) political changes in the Soviet Union	**Incorrect**: Gorbachev's perestroika and glasnost policies weakened the Soviet Union

2. Which presidential administration is considered most responsible for the end of the Cold War?

(A) Jimmy Carter	**Incorrect**: America's standing in the world was somewhat weakened under the Carter Administration as it inherited significant economic problems and exacerbated geopolitical issues.
(B) Richard Nixon	**Incorrect**: While Nixon's efforts at reducing tensions with China and the Soviet Union saw limited success and resulted in the end of American involvement in Vietnam, his administration's strategic arms limitation efforts ultimately failed.
(C) Ronald Reagan	**Correct**: Reagan persistently asserted U.S. opposition to communism through speeches, diplomatic efforts, limited military interventions, and a buildup of nuclear and conventional weapons.

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(D) Harry Truman	**Incorrect**: The Truman administration oversaw the first act of the Cold War and were in no position to see it ended. The dropping of the atomic bombs in Japan set the stage for this drawn out conflict between the US and the Soviet Union.

3. Which of the following developments in the late 20th Century and early 21st Century best represent the author's reference to a new "rearranged" world order?

(A) The increase in U.S.-led military interventions throughout the globe	**Correct**: Without the threat of a Soviet response, the US was able to unilaterally influence formerly "2nd World" and "3rd World" hot spots throughout the 1990s, such as Iraq, Somalia, and the former Yugoslavia.
(B) The decline in international trade due to the collapse of the Soviet Union	**Incorrect**: The total value of exported goods continued to rise even after the Soviet Union dissolved.
(C) Diplomatic relationships between the US, Russia, and China improved and flourished	**Incorrect**: Despite a friendly period under Gorbachev and Yeltsin, US-Russian relations were strained and ultimately deteriorated once Putin took office.
(D) Immigration from Asia and Latin America steadily declined	**Incorrect**: Immigration to the United States from places like the Philippines, China, Mexico, and Central American significantly increased in the 1990s and 2000s..

4. The ideas expressed in the excerpt were intended to address which of the following developments?

(A) Widespread corruption in the the corporate and banking world	**Incorrect**: Many deregulatory actions under Reagan contributed to an increase in corporate and banking growth, accompanied by degrees of corruption.
(B) Soviet criticisms of racial and socioeconomic injustice	**Incorrect**: The Soviet Union did point out the hypocrisies in American interventions around the world while, at the same time, glaring inequalities existed there. However, this was not a motivation for Reaganomics.

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(C) Stagnant economic growth and rapidly rising prices for goods	**Correct**: The term stagflation was coined in the 1970s in the United States during a severe recession. This significantly motivated Reagan's economic policies which ultimately won him the presidency in 1980.
(D) Unemployment caused by new manufacturing technologies	**Incorrect**: It wasn't until the 1980s that unemployment was significantly affected by new manufacturing technologies, such as automated roboticization.

5. Reagan's economic policies represented a significant departure from all of the following developments in the previous century except

(A) Progressive Era	**Incorrect**: The Progressive Era saw a government-led effort to regulate the economy and promote social and political reforms.
(B) Return to Normalcy	**Correct**: President Harding's campaign slogan in 1920 represented a return to laissez- faire economic policies akin to those of the Gilded Age. Reagan's call for deregulation, tax-cuts, and downsizing the government struck a similar chord.
(C) New Deal	**Incorrect**: The New Deal significantly increased the scope of the government and its spending.
(D) Great Society	**Incorrect**: The Great Society saw a continuation of the New Deal's efforts, promoting the working class through government-funded socioeconomic "safety nets".

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6. The actions depicted in the cartoon were primarily taken in response to

(A)	immigration from poor and war torn countries instilled fear in many Americans.	**Incorrect**: While Islamophobia contributed to the invasive measures of the Patriot Act, it was not the primary motivation.
(B)	american militant groups within the country posed a threat to the government.	**Incorrect**: The growing "patriot" movement did (and does) pose a threat to American governance, as seen in the Oklahoma City bombing in 1995. However, surveillance efforts increased even more so after 9/11.
(C)	popular culture's obsession with new reality television programs.	**Incorrect**: Reality TV shows are mostly voluntary, meaning the "actors" are aware of their role in the show. The cartoon depicts a figure who is seemingly ignorant of being watched.
(D)	increased concerns for national security following the September 11 terrorist attacks.	**Correct**: The Patriot Act significantly increased the US government's ability to monitor its citizens through numerous mediums with the goal of unveiling terrorist activity before another attack occurred.

7. The most significant effect of the situation depicted in the cartoon was

(A)	more prevalent and serious acts of terror as retaliation.	**Incorrect**: No terrorist attack on American soil has surpassed the death toll of 9/11.
(B)	concerns over the protection of civil liberties and human rights.	**Correct**: The National Security Administration (NSA) came under intense scrutiny in 2014 for its surveillance of telephone records.
(C)	boycotting of companies involved in the surveillance efforts.	**Incorrect**: Some companies, including Verizon, were embroiled in controversy due to their compliance with NSA requests for data, but no significant boycotts occurred.
(D)	the suppression of American individuality	**Incorrect**: The individuality of Americans was not substantially affected by new surveillance efforts.

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8. Which of the following developments allowed the situation depicted in the cartoon to expand significantly in the early 2000s?

(A) Increased public access to the internet	**Correct**: The advent of online communication and social media led to Americans, and people around the world, willingly creating a data profile that governments and corporations could access.
(B) Legislation promoting the use of more advanced satellites	**Incorrect**: Satellite technology did expand the reach and access to the internet but did not directly expand surveillance efforts like the internet did.
(C) The invention of new cameras with greater range and megapixels	**Incorrect**: Camera technology, like most other areas, continued to improve but did not expand surveillance efforts like the internet did.
(D) Government nationalization of American technology companies	**Incorrect**: The US government has not nationalized tech companies.

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